

Curriculum Accessibility Guide

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Linking to Content

Links with text that say "here" or "click here" are bad for accessibility. Make sure you use our linking conventions, ie, "Refresh yourself on [creating empathy maps](url)."

Referring to a section in a screencast/a program

Start with the quadrant location (like upper right or lower left), then the descriptor (green button, hamburger menu, etc.).

Images & Gifs

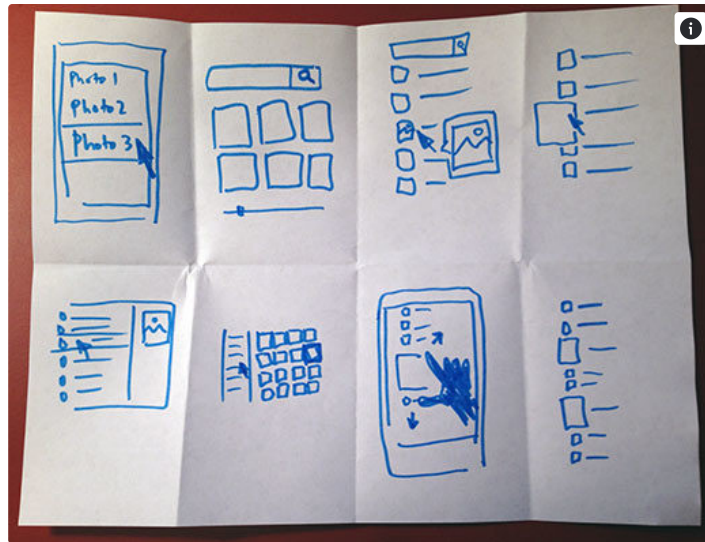
Any images or gifs added to steps should be high-quality and clear, so they appear crisp on the platform. In the doc, you'll center the image/gif, add a caption, and use a comment to indicate the alt text. Add media to the Images & Gifs folder in the lesson.

To create your own gifs, review the [Create an Animated Gif](#) page.

Captions

Image captions should be concise, conversational in tone, and should tie the image back to the topic at hand. They should be font size 10.

[Example from 108:](#)



A crazy 8s sketch for a mobile app - quick and gritty! Source: Fastcompany.com

Citing Sources

For any graphics that were not created in-house, site and link the graphic by writing *Source:*

Websitename.com

Be sure to link *directly* to the image. For the image above, for example, the source link goes to https://images.fastcompany.net/image/upload/w_1400,ar_16:9,c_fill,g_auto,f_auto,q_auto,fl_lossy/wp-cms/uploads/2013/12/1672917-poster-1280-storyboard2.jpg.

Alt Text

Alt text is code added to the HTML alt attribute of images and gifs. The text in the alt attribute is displayed on the screen if there's an error and the image doesn't load. Alt text is also used by visually impaired users that have a screen reader application. The screen reader reads the text in the alt attribute aloud to describe the image or gif.

While similar, alt text is not the same as an image caption. Alt text should describe what the image or gif shows and looks like. A caption may describe the image or gif, but it also can provide additional information and context for the media. Captions are available for all users while alt text is hidden from sighted users.

Here are some tips for writing great alt text:

- **Keep it brief** - Use only around 125 characters or less in the description.
- **Get right to the point** - Don't include "image of" and "gif of" or similar wording in the description, the user or screen reader knows it's an image.
- **Don't duplicate the caption** - Prevent the screen reader from reading the same thing twice by differing the content of the caption and alt text.

- **Describe the image's content and intention** - Think about why you're using the image. Are there visual characteristics the visitor needs to know about? Is there meaning and context the visitor would miss if they can't view the image? Sometimes an image is just an icon or logo and doesn't require much explanation. Other times, the image conveys deep meaning and needs a more thorough alt text.

The course loader will add the alt text to the class platform. The Curriculum Team member will need to indicate what alt text should be by adding a comment to the image.

In the comment, write the alt text, for example:

- alt = Metropolitan area populations bar chart. Tokyo has the highest population followed by Mumbai, Delhi, and Dhaka
- alt = Tree metaphor with trunk representing the master branch. Branches are a copy of the master branch and leaves are the commits.

Note: When naming the images or gifs for lessons, add the class number, lesson number, step, and a brief description. For example, “102-L01-READ-camel-case.png” and “C01-L05-Challenge1-professional-brand.png”.